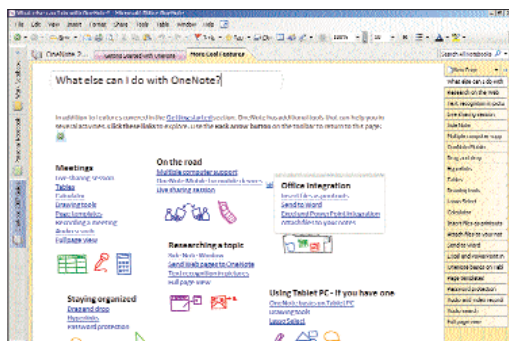




Make sure to read the Getting Started guide the first time you use OneNote

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The beauty of OneNote lies in the fact that there's no right or wrong way to use it. Whether you're a teacher organising your yearly syllabus, a doctor keeping notes on patients, a manager monitoring his team's performance, or a group who want to collaborate and share ideas and research, there's no real template or procedure to follow.

Apart from professional use, OneNote can also help you organise yourself—manage your shopping lists, help you keep track of your many boyfriends/girlfriends... anything! Essentially, if there's something you want to do, and it involves remembering something or refers to something else, you can use OneNote to do it easily and better!

Getting Started...

By default, when you start OneNote 2007, it opens with the "Getting Started with OneNote" tab. This handy guide is something you just *have* to read through at least once, because it will answer a lot of questions you will ask later on.

That done, you should get a basic idea of how and when to use OneNote. From now on, we'll assume you've read that guide, and have no doubts about when to use this software. We'll now go on to telling you how to put it to use.

The first thing you should do, provided you have the time and inclination, is to go to **File > New > Notebook** and take a look at the templates of notebooks that OneNote has ready for you. You don't have to follow these templates, of course, but it will give you a fair idea of what this software is capable of.

After you open a notebook of your choice, it's time to understand the layout of the pages you will come across.

Apart from the Standard menu and Formatting buttons at the top, there are three areas to the interface. On the left you will see a thin vertical bar that displays all your Notebooks. Exactly as the name suggests, each Notebook is like a physical file folder—it can be filled with notes, scraps, cut-outs, pictures, and more. In this case, of course, these "scraps" of information are all digital. You can quickly skip from one Notebook to another by clicking on the tabs at the left of the interface.

On the right you will find a list of "Pages", which, again, exactly as the name suggests, are digital versions of pages in a notebook. One you've filled up a page, you can just add another one and continue with your notes. Of course, you don't have to wait for a page to be filled before you move on to another, because if you really want to be organised,

you can give your pages descriptive names and put different types of content together—like all Web links in a page called "Links" and images in a page called "Pictures"... or not!

As we said earlier, the beauty of this software lies in the fact that there are no rules to follow; as long as it makes sense to you and serves its purpose, there's nothing to stop you from putting images in a page called "1" and links in a page called "Hakunamatata"!

At the top, below the standard buttons and menus, you will see what is called the Section bar. Here, you can further organise your pages into sections. This is much like the drawers and compartments in a cupboard—like separating the whites from the colours before again segregating shirts and trousers!

Again, using this is completely your choice.

Get Those Notebooks Out

One you have created the notebook of your choice, you can start jotting your thoughts and research down. In order to add text, just type anywhere, then drag it to the spot you want to place it in. The same applies for images, audio/video clips, links, Web pages, anything.

You can change the way the Notebooks panel on the left is displayed by clicking the ">>" button at the top to give you a more detailed view of the Notebooks and their contents.

If you use Internet Explorer (6 or later), adding what you find online to OneNote is as simple as clicking a button. After you've used OneNote for the first time, you will find a taskbar icon appear, which will let you add elements to your notes. In Internet Explorer 7, under the Tools menu you will find "Send to OneNote", so you can easily add Web pages to your Notebook.

While you have the OneNote icon in the taskbar, you can use **[Windows] + [S]** to take a screen clipping. This is similar to a screenshot, but you drag the mouse and make a selection box so that you only get the required area in the image. This is then automatically added to your open Notebook, and then you can set comments for it.

Search And More Cool Things

If you're putting your thoughts down in OneNote, it's obvious that you should be able to find them when you need them. This is where the search function comes in handy: not only can you search through text, you can also do so in images (or rather the text that may be in images) as well. This works in the same way OCR does, and tries to recognise characters in images. So if you have scanned business cards, just pop them into your Notebook called Contacts (for the current project) and then just search for names when you need them.

When you add documents into your Notebook, you're asked whether you want to include a link, a copy or a "printout," which is nothing but an image of the print preview of the document.

Because OneNote integrates seamlessly with Outlook as well, if there's a mail that relates to the project that your Notebook is organising, just drag it into OneNote. You can also set Outlook tasks from within OneNote, all you have to do is click on the Tasks button or go to **Insert > Outlook Task**.

OneNote On The Move

If you own a PocketPC or Windows Mobile device, you can jot down and save notes into them and synchronise them later with your desktop/laptop. There's no additional software to buy or download either—all you have to do is go to **Tools > Options > OneNote Mobile > Install OneNote Mobile** after you've connected your device to your PC. This will install OneNote mobile to your phone, and now you can take notes wherever you go.